STATE SCAN

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MP: A DIP IN TROUBLED WATERS *PG 18*



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GOING UP New deputy CM Harsh Sanghavi with CM Bhupendra Patel

▶ GUJARAT

HEIR APPARENT

Harsh Sanghavi, coronated as deputy CM, is the new No. 2 in Gujarat

By **Jumana Shah**

A GASP OF SURPRISE ROSE UP IN THE convention hall of Mahatma Mandir as Harsh Sanghavi took oath as Gujarat's deputy chief minister. To be sure, this scion of an affluent Jain family in the diamond business, a beaver-like MoS with a raft of portfolios, was set for an elevation to cabinet level. The previous day had seen 16 ministerial resignations—the second time the Gujarat cabinet was made to exit en masse. In 2021, when the Vijay Rupani cabinet was decommissioned, it included the CM. This time, Bhupendra Patel was safe. But everyone was taken aback by the new 40-year-old installed by his side in the October 17 reboot.

But Sanghavi didn't take long to adjust from junior minister to state No. 2. As the 25 other inductees came up to the CM after their swearing-in, Patel stood up and greeted each one. Sanghavi remained seated, offering only a cursory handshake to colleagues decades senior to him. Thus were new power equations established. The man of the moment, judging by all cues, is the man to watch out for in the next few decades. The reshuffle, precipitated by former MoS Jagdish Vishwakarma's appointment as BJP's state president, was on the cards for at